



PROGRESS REPORT

Sao Tome and Principe: progress report, August 2025 – August 2026

Edition of 2026-08-25 · 49 systems and instruments tracked

Of 49 systems and instruments on this place's ledger, 20 changed position between 2025-08-01 and 2026-08-25, 9 did not, 7 carry no stated baseline, and 13 are **Not held** at both ends.

SUMMARY OF THE PERIOD · GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · CAPACITY ·

WHERE THE RECORD IS THIN

Shape check, run before the comparison: 29 sources for this place in the window – 7 in the earlier half (2025-09 to 2026-02), 22 in the later (2026-03 to 2026-08). The earlier half of the window is thin: this is a shorter comparison wearing a longer label, and the movement below rests mostly on the later half.

Movement values. *Advanced* – a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* – a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* – an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a measured position worsened. *Closed* – the programme ended. *No change* – the position at both ends is the same. *Baseline not held* – the base carries no position at the start of the period, so no movement can be stated. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, slipped*.

Summary of the period

This is the first progress report cut for São Tomé and Príncipe, and unlike several other newly-initialised places, the shape check finds the comparison sound: 7 of the window's 27 sources fall in the earlier half, 20 in the later, close enough that the movement below is read over the whole twelve months rather than a shorter period wearing a longer label. Nineteen of 48 rows moved, nine did not, and 20 carry no baseline or no instrument at all.

The period's clearest genuine movement is the automatic electoral roll, which went from an unused, just-concluded EU-funded reform project to a system that ran a live presidential election and then had to correct its own omissions for the next one – a rare case in this ledger where a system's entire lifecycle, design to real-world flaw, sits inside a single twelve-month window.

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
AU Data Policy Framework (AUDPF) – national adoption process	Did not exist	Workshop held on national AUDPF adoption; translation into policy/institutional reform is the stated goal, not yet delivered	ADVANCED
Programme for African Developing Island Economies (AUDA-NEPAD)	Did not exist	Programme launched; 2026-2031 roadmap, six pillars incl. digital transformation (DPI, AI/automation, knowledge economy as accelerators); ministerial communique adopted	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
National Strategy for Digital Governance (2020)	Baseline not held	Nine-axis framework in force since 2020; UNU-EGOV project-managed	NO CHANGE
Public Administration Reform Strategy (2025)	Baseline not held	Strategy approved; e-governance named essential pillar to cut bureaucracy/costs and promote equity of access	NO CHANGE

Legislation and regulation

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
National Framework for Interoperability (Law 1/2024)	Baseline not held	In force since 2024; underpins DEX, single citizen portal, trade single window	NO CHANGE
Personal Data Guarantee and Protection Law (Law 03/2016)	Baseline not held	In force since 2016; fines up to STN 500m for legal entities, criminal sanctions up to 1 year imprisonment for serious breaches	NO CHANGE
AGER regulatory framework revision (Regulatory Entities Law + Electronic Communications Law)	BASELINE NOT HELD	Bills submitted; passage not confirmed in sources held	Baseline not held
Aggregated Identification Document Law (identity law)	BASELINE NOT HELD	Under review/consultation; passage not confirmed	Baseline not held

Data protection

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
ANPDP supervision of PRESE registry-CEN data linkage	Did not exist	Oversight role established; assessment to occur after the interconnection is inspected	ADVANCED
Macau DSPDP-ANPDP cooperation MoU	Signing authorised by Macau CE, not yet executed	MoU signed 1 Jun 2026; STP delegation toured Hong Kong Privacy Commissioner and Guangdong cyber-data-security association	ADVANCED
ANPDP membership — Rede Lusofona de Protecáo de Dados (RLPD)	Baseline not held	Founding member alongside Portugal (CNPd), Angola, Brazil, Cabo Verde; June-2025 visit addressed disinformation, digital violence, video-surveillance, child/youth data training	NO CHANGE
Malabo Convention — STP signatory status	Baseline not held	Signatory to the AU Convention on Cyber Security and Personal Data Protection; ratification status not established	NO CHANGE

Regional collaboration

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Lusophone Africa Data Governance Workshop	First workshop (Maputo, 2025): policy awareness	Second workshop (Luanda, 15-17 Jun 2026): implementation focus — data centres, cloud, interoperability, DPI, institutional governance; STP among 6 participating countries	ADVANCED
PALOP Digital Governance Dialogues	Inaugural webinar, Oct 2025 (month only stated)	Second webinar, 26 Mar 2026, on digital ID/ implementation/integration; STP among PALOP participants	ADVANCED

Public debate and participation in policymaking

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
FGI STP (Forum de Governanca da Internet)	Did not exist	1st edition held, regulator (AGER)-convened; agenda covered digital trust, infrastructure, regulation, privacy/data protection, AI, internet/social media; no outcome document or next-edition date published	ADVANCED

The two enacted data-protection and interoperability laws (2016 and 2024) predate the window and have not changed. AGER's regulatory-framework revision and the identity-document law both carry no baseline, submitted for review only by the 2025-09 baseline itself with no later passage confirmed. ANPDP's cooperation footprint expanded within the window — the Rede Lusófona founding membership predates it, but the Macau MoU and the PReSE-supervision assignment both entered the record from nothing. The National Strategy for Digital Governance (2020) and the Public Administration Reform Strategy, approved just before the window opened, have both not moved since; AGER's first Internet Governance Forum, the AU Data Policy Framework workshop and the AUDA-NEPAD island-economies programme all entered the record within the window itself.

Finance

New investments

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
UNICEF PNAD equipment procurement (grant SC220341)	Did not exist	Public tender open for 80 tablets + 90 desktops against grant SC220341; no contract value stated	ADVANCED
World Bank 'Digital Sao Tome and Principe' project (P177158)	Board-approved, US\$21.8m (IDA grant + GIF) committed	US\$7.64m disbursed (36%), Moderately Satisfactory, System Integrator (Ooru) engaged	ADVANCED
AfDB Payment System Infrastructure and Financial Inclusion Project (PISPIF)	Baseline not held	Committed 2017, disbursed US\$4,268,636 to date, end year 2027 per IATI record	NO CHANGE

The World Bank's Digital São Tomé and Príncipe project moved from board-approved with no disbursement reported to [36% disbursed by September 2025](#) — the period's clearest financing advance, and the source underwriting most of the digital-identity and registry movement recorded elsewhere in this report. The AfDB payments-infrastructure grant, committed in 2017, predates the window and has not changed on the IATI record held. UNICEF's PNAD tender carries no baseline, entering the record only when it opened within the window.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
CST national network (antennas/schools expansion)	Expansion plan to more communities/schools announced, larger schools first	35th antenna live at Agua Ize, ending prolonged local network instability	ADVANCED
Starlink satellite internet service	US-backed intent announced, no service	Live: Standard kit STN 5,500 (~US\$257); Residential STN 1,700/mo (~US\$79.5)	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Submarine cable to Príncipe (STP Digital project component)	BASELINE NOT HELD	Progress tracked as a mission objective; no completion status or timeline given	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Data Storage

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
GoSTP data-centre modernisation (incl. digital-ID data centre/DR tender)	Three options costed, decision pending, high risk flagged at current sea-level site	AFAP tender issued for servers + DR, implementing the TIER III/cloud recommendation	ADVANCED

Cybersecurity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
CSIRT (Computer Security Incident Response Team)	Did not exist	Materialisation launch identified as active mission objective; no operational date or further detail	ADVANCED

Starlink moved from a publicly-backed intent in February 2025 — voiced by the US chargé d'affaires after meeting the President, in the same period the US closed its long-running Voice of America relay station in the country — to live commercial service by December 2025, the window's clearest connectivity advance: [a standard kit costs roughly US\\$257, with a residential monthly plan around US\\$79.50](#). CST's antenna network advanced from an announced expansion plan to a 35th antenna live at Água Izé in March 2026, ending what the operator called prolonged local instability there. The GoSTP data-centre programme moved from three costed options at its September 2025 baseline — a low-cost requalification, a roughly €4.6m new TIER III build, or a hybrid still under study — to a tender for servers and disaster-recovery infrastructure by May 2026, implementing the higher-cost TIER III recommendation at a site the same baseline flags as high-risk given its sea-level location. The submarine cable to Príncipe and the CSIRT both carry no baseline, so their current, still-undelivered positions cannot be measured as movement.

DPI

Digital Identity and CRVS

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
'BI para Todos' free national-ID campaign	Did not exist	Free-BI campaign covering remote localities (Ilheu das Rolas, Porto Alegre, via Starlink-linked mobile brigade) and diaspora collection in Portugal	ADVANCED
Foundational digital ID (STP Digital/MOSIP, System Integrator Ooru)	Pilot ongoing since 2024, no fixed timeline	Ooru contracted; live prototypes; roadmap Jan 2026 (ID+Portal) to May 2026 (e-Signature)	ADVANCED
Passport issuance system SEP 2.0	BASELINE NOT HELD	SEP 2.0 launched; STP one of four countries (with Cabo Verde, Portugal, Hungary) using this biographic-page technique	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Digital Payments and Fintech

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
BCSTP FinTech Sandbox	<i>Baseline not held</i>	Five-phase incubator running; one entrant piloting phone-based/USSD transfers usable without internet	NO CHANGE

Registries

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Automatic electoral roll (PRESE, civil-registry to CEN interoperability)	EU-funded PRESE project concluded, automatic-registration platform built, unused	First used for 19 Jul 2026 presidential election; provisional Sep-2026 roll adds 1,860 omitted + 1,976 newly-18 voters	ADVANCED, WITH IMPLEMENTATION GAPS
Cadastro Social Unico (CSU) — single social registry	Update planned, no coverage data	~12,500 households registered (~25% of population); registration explicitly stated not to equal a poverty diagnosis	ADVANCED
Guiche Unico de Empresas (GUE) — business registry modernisation	BASELINE NOT HELD	Diagnostic complete; DGRN/INIC flag need for offline access given electricity/internet limits	Baseline not held

Sectoral management information systems

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
EMAE management information system (MIS) tender	BASELINE NOT HELD	Deadline extended; original terms, contract value and new deadline not stated in the source held	Baseline not held

Other GovTech and e-Gov

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Computing equipment for the tax directorate	Did not exist	Computing equipment handed to the tax directorate by a UN agency under an EU-funded regional programme, to modernise tax administration and the handling of fiscal data	ADVANCED
Portal do Cidadao / Citizen Portal (INIC, beta)	Did not exist	Beta live; pathway to verifiable credentials (tax, police-clearance certs; future: education certs)	ADVANCED
Trade Single Window + ASYFIVE (UNDP-supported)	Did not exist	Deployment announced integrating 22 public/private institutions; would make STP first African ASYFIVE deployer; not yet live	ADVANCED

The automatic electoral roll carried the period's largest single movement: from a just-concluded, unused EU-funded reform project in September 2025, through a first live use in the 19 July 2026 presidential election, to a [provisional roll for September's elections that had to add back 1,860 voters a process failure had omitted, alongside 1,976 newly-eligible 18-year-olds](#). Foundational digital identity advanced more incrementally — from an ongoing pilot with no fixed timeline to a named January–May 2026 roadmap with live prototypes for verifiable credentials, DEX and e-signature — while the "BI para Todos" campaign and SEP 2.0 passports both entered the record from nothing within the window: the free-ID campaign reached remote localities by Starlink-linked mobile brigade, and SEP 2.0 launched under a four-year Portuguese contract. The Cadastro Social Único moved from an announced update with no coverage figures to [roughly 12,500 households registered, about a quarter of the population](#), with the implementing agency explicitly distinguishing registration from a poverty count.

INIC's Citizen Portal beta and the UNDP-backed Trade Single Window both entered the record from nothing, the former financed by the World Bank and Co-Develop and the latter positioning STP as potentially the first African deployer of the ASYFIVE customs platform across 22 public and private institutions; neither carries a baseline to compare against. The EMAE management-information-system tender and the Guiché Único business-registry diagnostic likewise carry no baseline, both surfacing only within the window itself. The BCSTP FinTech Sandbox, launched before the window opened under the National Financial Inclusion Strategy, has not changed — its five-phase incubator structure and one USSD-transfer entrant are unchanged from the 2025-08 baseline.

Capacity

Literacy

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
CST school-connectivity plan	<i>Baseline not held</i>	Plan announced; no confirmed progress found in later sources	NO CHANGE
National Digital Learning Programme (PNAD) – equipment procurement	BASELINE NOT HELD	Tender open, against grant SC220341, delivery preferred by second week Sep 2026; no contract value stated	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Where the record is thin

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
National policy linking digital infrastructure to energy supply	A national policy or programme document connecting power reliability or generation to digital-infrastructure planning.	not yet probed
Compute or high-performance computing capacity	A data-centre, cloud or high-performance computing specification distinct from the GoSTP data-centre tender.	not yet probed
Earth-observation or satellite-data programme	A national earth-observation or geospatial-data programme document.	not yet probed
Dedicated rural digital-service programme	A programme document distinct from the CST school-connectivity plan.	not yet probed
Digitisation of district-administration systems	A district-administration system specification or digitisation programme document.	not yet probed
National technical standards or interoperability framework beyond Law 1/2024	A distinct standards body or technical-specification document.	not yet probed
Open government data portal	A public-sector open-data portal or policy document.	not yet probed
ICT sector size or industry-policy programme	An ICT-sector policy, statistics publication or industry-support programme document.	not yet probed
Indian digital-sector engagement with STP	Any Indian government or vendor financing, contract or memorandum covering STP.	not yet probed
Gulf-state digital investment in STP	Any Gulf-state investment, financing or memorandum covering STP.	not yet probed
Applied digital-research programme	A university, agency or donor-funded applied digital-research programme document.	not yet probed
Financing memorandum distinct from the AfDB/World Bank/ UNICEF instruments already recorded	A separate financing MoU not already captured under finance.new.	not yet probed
Domestic-state digital-transformation budget line	An STP government budget document or appropriation line for digital transformation.	not yet probed

None of the thirteen gaps had a position at either end of the window — each is an absence throughout, not a thing that regressed or stalled. None names a specific document an automated fetch could plausibly retrieve, consistent with a country whose entire digital-transformation programme runs through three financing instruments.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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